The bill that was introduced for discussion was actually three bills, one drafted by Netanyahu, and the other two by his more right-wing coalition partners. The drafts were similar in many ways, reaffirming banal facets of Israel's identity like the national anthem or the design of the flag. But the right-wing versions went a few steps further. One demoted Arabic from its status as an official language, and encouraged Israel to expand its settlements in the occupied territories; both defined the country as having only a "democratic *form* of government" (emphasis mine), rather than explicitly labeling it a "Jewish and democratic state." All three also stated that Jewish law would be "a source of inspiration" for the Knesset and the courts. It was more or less the language that Stern warned about six months earlier.

## *"Your father was a hero"*

In the middle of all this, I went back up to the Galilee, this time to meet the relatives of an Israeli policeman who had given his life for a state that was debating whether to label him a second-class citizen.

Zidan Seif, a traffic cop, was one of the first officers to arrive at the Har Nof synagogue. The police said he had played a key role in stopping the attack. In a video of the incident later aired on Channel 2, it appeared that Seif had wounded one of the two Palestinian attackers before he was shot in the head at close range.

Thousands of Israelis of all ethnicities and religions attended his funeral in Yanuh-Jat. President Rivlin delivered a powerful eulogy, addressing some of his words to Seif's four-month-old daughter. "We will tell her that her father heroically defended Jerusalem," he said. "Your father was a hero, whose death meant that many others lived." Both Israelis and diaspora Jews rallied behind the surviving family members, raising tens of thousands of dollars in donations in a matter of weeks.

But these gestures did not blunt a sense of betrayal in the Druze community. They have sent their sons to the army, often in combat roles, for more than half a century. Ayoub Kara, a Druze lawmaker from Likud, said that about 85 per cent of their men perform military service—compared to 75 per cent of Jewish men. Jewish politicians often talk of a "covenant of blood" (*brit dam*) between the two communities. The Druze commander of the army's elite Golani brigade, Col Ghassan Alian, was injured by a